8.5 INTERBASE

InterBase is a full-featured database that spent much of its life as closed-source and proprietary. In January 2000, Inprise released InterBase under an open source license, allowing everyone access to the source code. InterBase is the first **open source database** to be compliant with the SQL 92 standard. Under commercial development for more than 16 years, InterBase compares favorably to Oracle, Sybase, and IBM's DB2. We discuss the PHP functions for communicating with InterBase, but a tutorial on InterBase itself is out of scope.

Keyword

Open source database is any database application with a codebase that is free to view, download, modify, distribute, and reuse.



InterBase support was added to PHP by Jouni Ahto. Later work was done by Andrew Avdeev and Ivo Panacek. At the time of writing, InterBase functions in PHP were not complete, but the recent change in licensing will probably encourage developers. You also have the option of using the ODBC functions.

boolean ibase_blob_add(integer blob, string data)

The ibase_blob_add function adds data to a blob. You must create the blob first with ibase_blob_create.

boolean ibase_blob_cancel(integer blob)

Use ibase_blob_cancel to discard a blob you have created with ibase_blob_create.